

WATER SAFETY

Visual Guide

Accessible Resource for Diverse Learners | Year 7-8 HPE

Large text, clear visuals, and simple language (approx. Year 4-5 reading level).
For EAL/D learners, students with learning difficulties, and low-literacy students.
Pair with oral explanation and the scenario activity cards.

Teacher note:

This resource uses large text, strong colour contrast, simple language (approx. Year 4-5 reading level), and clear visual structure. All core Year 7-8 water safety concepts are covered. Best used alongside oral explanation and the scenario activity cards. Pair with the Scenario Cards for group discussion activities.

THE 5 WATER SAFETY RULES**1****RULE 1****READ THE SIGNS**

Always check flags and warning signs **BEFORE** you swim.

2**RULE 2****ENTER FEET FIRST**

NEVER dive into water you do not know. Always go in feet first.

3**RULE 3****STAY IN YOUR DEPTH**

Only swim where you can touch the bottom if you need to.

4**RULE 4****SWIM WITH A FRIEND**

NEVER swim alone. Always have someone with you.

5**RULE 5****SIGNAL FOR HELP**

If you need help — raise **ONE** arm up **HIGH** and hold it there.

BEACH FLAGS — WHAT DO THEY MEAN?**RED & YELLOW FLAGS
SWIM HERE**

A lifeguard **IS** watching. This is the **SAFEST** spot. **ALWAYS** swim between these flags at a patrolled beach.

**SINGLE RED FLAG
DANGER — CONDITIONS VERY BAD**

Conditions are very bad. Do **NOT** swim here. Experienced swimmers only — extreme caution required.

ORANGE WINDSOCK FLAG NO INFLATABLES

Strong wind is blowing OUT to sea. NO pool toys, rings, or inflatables — they will blow away and cannot come back.

PURPLE FLAG MARINE DANGER

Dangerous sea creatures are in the water (e.g. jellyfish or sharks). Do NOT enter the water.

CAUGHT IN A RIP? WHAT TO DO

A rip is a fast stream of water that pulls you OUT to sea.

Do NOT fight it! If you swim against it, you will get too tired to survive. Your energy is your most important resource — do not waste it.

1

STAY CALM

Do not panic. Panic makes everything worse.

2

FLOAT

Save your energy. Float on your back if you can.

3

SWIM SIDWAYS

Swim parallel to the shore — NOT straight back. Never fight the rip directly.

4

ANGLE BACK IN

Once you are out of the rip, angle gently back toward the shore.

5

RAISE ONE ARM

Signal for help — raise ONE arm straight up and hold it there.

EMERGENCY — DRS ABCD

Someone is hurt near water? Use DRS ABCD — in this order, every time.

DRS ABCD is Australia's standard emergency action plan. Learn each step. Follow them in order.

D
DANGER

Is it safe for you?

R
RESPONSE

Tap & call their name

S
SEND 000

Call for help NOW

A
AIRWAY

Tilt head back gently

B
BREATHING

Look, listen, feel

C
CPR

30 pushes + 2 breaths

D
DEFIB

Use AED if available

D	DANGER	Check it is SAFE before you approach anyone. Do not rush in — you could become a second casualty.
R	RESPONSE	Tap their shoulders firmly. Call their name loudly. No response = they are unconscious.
S	SEND FOR HELP	Call 000 immediately. Or point to one person: "YOU — call 000 right now." Give your exact location.
A	AIRWAY	Gently tilt their head back to open the airway. This stops the tongue blocking their throat.
B	BREATHING	Look, listen, and feel for breathing — 10 seconds. Look for chest rising. Listen for breath sounds.
C	CPR	30 chest compressions, then 2 rescue breaths. Push HARD and FAST — 100-120 beats per minute, 5-6 cm deep.
D	DEFIB	Use an AED (defibrillator) if one is available nearby. It will give you instructions — it is safe for anyone to use.

RESCUING SOMEONE — THROW, DON'T GO

NEVER jump in to rescue someone if you are not trained.

A panicking drowning person can pull an untrained rescuer underwater. You could become a second victim. Throw something instead — then call 000 and talk them in from the edge.

YES — DO THIS	NO — DON'T DO THIS
+ Call 000 FIRST	- Jump in after them if you are not trained
+ Throw a rope, towel, pool noodle, or anything that floats	- Panic — panicking wastes time
+ Talk to them — keep them calm	- Try to grab their hand by leaning over
+ Stay on the edge — do NOT go into the water	- Assume someone else will call 000
+ Pull them in using what you threw	

HIDDEN DANGERS AT RIVERS, DAMS & LAKES

These dangers are INVISIBLE from above the water.

That is what makes them so dangerous. The water can look completely calm, shallow, and safe — but still be deadly.

HIDDEN WEEDS	Trap your legs and feet so you cannot swim COLD WATER
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ROCKS & LOGS	HIDDEN CURRENTS Fast currents — invisible from above
NO LIFEGUARD	NO PHONE Not on phone — nobody will call 000 for you

QUICK CHECK — WHAT DO YOU REMEMBER?

Q1: Name the 5 SwimSafe rules in order: 	Q2: What do red and yellow flags mean?
Q3: If you are caught in a rip — what should you do FIRST? 	Q4: What does DRS stand for in DRS ABCD?
Q5: Why should you NOT jump in to rescue someone if you are not trained? 	Q6: Name ONE hidden danger you cannot see at a river or dam: